

A REUSABLE FIELD COMPANION

The Warrior Teacher's Playbook

A Field Journal for Turning Strategy into Practice

Print the pages you need. Complete them digitally. Return to them whenever the field changes.

MATTHEW PHAM

COMPANION TO THE ART OF WAR FOR EDUCATORS

How to Use This Companion

A field journal becomes useful only when it helps you see, choose, and learn more honestly.

This companion does not turn teaching or leadership into a formula. It gives the questions in the Playbook enough space to be used more than once, in more than one room, and with more than one kind of learner.

USE IT IN THREE WAYS

Before the moment

Prepare for a lesson, meeting, conversation, transition, or decision that matters.

After the moment

Study what happened without letting the first emotional story become the final explanation.

With another perspective

Invite a learner, colleague, family member, support professional, work sample, or responsible AI use to test what you think you saw.

WHAT THE MARKS MEAN

A checkbox belongs beside something you can honestly observe, confirm, or complete. A response field asks you to gather evidence, slow down, and decide what the moment requires. There is no correct way to complete this companion. Write, speak, discuss, or use one page and leave the rest untouched. Blank space does not mean unfinished work.

Professional and information boundary

This is practitioner reflection, not a diagnostic instrument or validated intervention. Keep completed pages private and secure. Enter no names, nicknames, pseudonyms, traceable learner codes, confidential records, diagnoses, safeguarding information, private communications, or protected work. Keep identifiable evidence in the institution's authorized process.

Choose the Depth the Moment Requires

Do not begin with the biggest tool. Begin with the smallest page capable of improving the next decision.

QUICK MOVE

Five minutes or less: Strategic Pause, 5-Minute Lesson Audit, or Monday Move.

DEEPER REFLECTION

Understand a learner, relationship, or recurring pattern: Reading the Room, Strength Finder, Self-Check, or Pattern Practice.

ETHICAL DECISION

Working with a powerful method, sensitive information, or AI: Ethical Ignition, Foreknowledge, CRIT + Human Check, or the 20/80 Value Audit.

LONGER INQUIRY

Study change across sessions, weeks, or cycles: Growth Evidence Tracker or Terrain Inquiry Cycle.

A SIMPLE STARTING SEQUENCE

- ☐ Pause once before reacting.
- ☐ Read one real moment without assigning motive.
- ☐ Choose one small move.
- ☐ Watch for evidence that supports or challenges your reading.
- ☐ Return and revise.

The deeper tools are not more important.

They simply give a complex moment more room. A small page used honestly is stronger than an impressive framework used carelessly.

Translate the Language Without Losing the Purpose

The Playbook belongs in classrooms, but its responsibility travels farther.

Teacher or educator

Coach, mentor, parent, counsellor, administrator, team leader, or designer

Learner or student

The person, group, or, where applicable, intelligent system whose growth you are supporting

Classroom

Studio, field, court, office, meeting, workshop, home, team, or digital environment

Lesson

Shared task, project, conversation, practice, decision, or next stage of growth

Learning evidence

What changed in demonstrated understanding, action, participation, ownership, relationship, or responsible performance

Keep the ethical centre

Whatever language you use, the person is never the enemy. The tool exists to protect purpose, dignity, agency, trust, and the possibility of growth.

An Optional Four-Week Practice Path

Use this only if a sequence helps. The Playbook should support the work, not become another burden.

WEEK 1 • NOTICE

Use the Strategic Pause once and Reading the Room once. Practise separating observation from assumption.

WEEK 2 • PROTECT

Use the Strength Finder and Teacher Self-Check. Practise holding both dignity and direction.

WEEK 3 • WIDEN

Use CRIT + Human Check, the 20/80 Value Audit, or another trusted perspective. Let new evidence change your mind.

WEEK 4 • STUDY

Use the optional Growth Evidence Tracker or Terrain Inquiry Cycle. Practise watching what changes across time.

My reason for beginning

What would make this practice worth the time?

Evidence I hope to notice

What change would matter without pretending one tool can prove causation?

Completed Example 1: Reading a Difficult Moment

This neutral example demonstrates the discipline of separating evidence from interpretation.

Situation

A group is talking during independent work.

Observed

Several learners are talking, two have stopped working, and the instructions remain visible.

First story

They are choosing not to care.

Alternative possibilities

The first step may be unclear, the task may need a smaller entry point, or the group may need a clearer time boundary.

Small move

Pause the room, restate the purpose, model the first step, and provide five focused minutes before checking again.

Signal

Are learners beginning, asking more useful questions, or repeating the same error or request for clarification?

Review

Keep the adjustment if it improves clarity and participation. Change it if the evidence shows that the barrier is somewhere else.

Completed Example 2: Responsible AI Use

This is an illustrative scenario, not a claim about one lived classroom.

Purpose

A teacher wants three alternative ways to explain equivalent fractions before meeting a group that struggled with the first explanation.

Use Gate

The exact system and purpose are authorized. The prompt includes only a public learning goal and a genuinely non-identifying task; changing a name is not treated as anonymity or permission.

What AI widened

It suggests a paper-folding model, a number-line comparison, and a shopping analogy.

What the teacher rejected

The shopping example assumes experiences that may not be shared and adds unnecessary language.

What the teacher checked and kept

The paper-folding and number-line models are mathematically verified, adapted to available materials, and selected because they preserve the learning intention.

Responsibility

The teacher decides what enters the room, watches how learners respond, and changes course if the new route does not help.

Why this is responsible

The system widens possibilities. The educator protects context, accuracy, privacy, ownership, and the final decision.

Completed Example 3: A Terrain Inquiry

This example shows how to study one adjustment without claiming that a single observation proves a universal result.

Question

Could a clearer material-return system reduce waiting and protect creation time during transitions?

Evidence before

Across three lessons, cleanup begins late, several learners wait without a role, and materials return to inconsistent places.

Adjustment

Introduce labelled return areas, two visible time warnings, and rotating student responsibilities.

Evidence after

During the next three lessons, more learners begin cleanup at the first cue and fewer ask where materials belong.

Another perspective

A teaching assistant notices that the final tables are restored more consistently but one role still creates a bottleneck.

Revision

Divide the overloaded role and observe again.

Honest conclusion

The adjustment appears useful in this setting. It deserves continued observation; it does not prove that the same design will work everywhere.

Field Tool 1: The Strategic Pause • Before

Use before a lesson, meeting, conversation, correction, or difficult decision.

Mission

What matters beyond completing the immediate task?

Learner or people in front of me

Who may be affected by this decision?

What I have actually observed

Record evidence without assigning motive or identity.

What I may be assuming

What story have I added?

What must be protected

Safety, dignity, trust, learning, time, relationship, or something else?

Smallest wise move

What can improve the situation without closing future possibilities?

Field Tool 1: The Strategic Pause • After

Return after the moment. The purpose is not to prove yourself right.

What actually happened

What changed, and what remained?

What the room revealed

What did the response tell me about clarity, energy, relationship, access, or purpose?

Where I read wisely

Which evidence supported my first reading?

Where I reacted

Where did emotion, ego, fatigue, or urgency narrow my view?

Perspective that challenges my account

What did another person, work sample, or later observation reveal?

What I will carry forward

Keep, adapt, release, or investigate?

Field Tool 2: The 5-Minute Lesson Audit

Check only what you can honestly confirm. An unchecked item shows where preparation may need attention.

- ☐ Purpose: The learning matters beyond completing the task.
- ☐ Clarity: Learners can see where to begin and what success may look like.
- ☐ Energy: I have considered whether this moment needs calm, momentum, curiosity, challenge, movement, or stillness.
- ☐ Access: I have prepared a bridge for anyone who may struggle to enter the learning.
- ☐ Extension: I have a meaningful next step for anyone who may be ready for more.

One adjustment before I begin

Fix one thing rather than redesigning everything.

Evidence I will watch for

What will tell me the adjustment is helping?

What I will do if the evidence disagrees

Prepare to change the route without abandoning the purpose.

One clear adjustment can protect an entire class.

Preparation is not control. It is care made visible before the moment asks for it.

Chapter 1 Field Notes: Laying Plans

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

What am I trying to build beyond the activity itself?

Where might my plan be clear to me but unclear to the learner?

What assumptions am I carrying into the room?

What would preparation look like if I planned for the learner, not only the lesson?

One move I will try

Before teaching, write one sentence that names the real purpose of the lesson. Not the task. The purpose.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Help me identify the deeper learning purpose behind this lesson and suggest three ways to make that purpose visible to learners.

Chapter 2 Field Notes: Waging War

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

Where am I spending energy without gaining learning?

What is exhausting me because the system is unclear?

What routine, boundary, or expectation needs to be strengthened?

Where am I relying on effort when a better structure would help everyone?

One move I will try

Choose one recurring problem and design one small routine that prevents it before it grows.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Here is a recurring challenge. Help me design a simple routine that protects learning while maintaining dignity.

Chapter 3 Field Notes: Attack by Stratagem

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

Where am I trying to force a result that could be reached more wisely?

What barrier is really standing between the learner and the learning?

How can I win the learner without fighting the learner?

Where can I protect the relationship while still protecting the standard?

One move I will try

Find one moment where you usually correct quickly. Pause first. Record what you observed, ask what context may be missing, and test more than one explanation before acting.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Here is a permitted, non-identifying observation of a classroom pattern. Generate several possible explanations, state what evidence would distinguish them, and suggest humane responses without lowering the expectation. Do not diagnose or infer an inner state.

Chapter 4 Field Notes: Tactical Dispositions

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

What conditions need to be in place before learners can succeed?

Where am I expecting fluent participation before I have created a safe way to begin?

What would make the learning environment more prepared?

What can I arrange now so learners do not have to fight unnecessary confusion later?

One move I will try

Set up one part of the environment, routine, or material flow so success becomes easier before the task begins.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Help me audit this learning experience for possible points of confusion or avoidable friction. Treat every explanation as a hypothesis to test.

Chapter 5 Field Notes: Energy

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

Where is the energy in the room coming from?

Where is it leaking?

What kind of energy does this group need from me today: calm, momentum, humour, clarity, challenge, or care?

Which small share of my decisions shapes most of the learning value, and which work is only friction?

One move I will try

Notice one moment when energy shifts. Name what changed before choosing your response.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Help me identify friction AI may appropriately reduce, then show me which human decisions, relationships, and productive struggle must remain protected. Treat 20/80 as a focus lens, not a formula.

Chapter 6 Field Notes: Weaknesses and Strengths

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

Whose observable work or participation have I not examined closely enough?

What strength, strategy, or success is visible in the learner's work?

Where have I accepted a label too quickly?

What might become possible if I looked again?

One move I will try

Choose one learner you have mostly seen through difficulty. Look again for one strength evidenced in work or participation, then create one opportunity to test it.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Here is a permitted, non-identifying description of an observable learning barrier. Suggest one strengths-based opportunity I could test. Do not infer ability, motive, emotion, personality, or identity.

Chapter 7 Field Notes: Maneuvering

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

Where is the path no longer clear?

What is the room asking me to adjust?

Am I holding the mission, or am I holding the plan?

What route could still lead to the same destination?

One move I will try

Prepare one alternate route before the lesson begins: another example, entry point, pace, or way back.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Give me three alternative routes into this learning: one visual, one hands-on, and one discussion-based.

Chapter 8 Field Notes: Variation in Tactics

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

What usual method might not be the right method for this moment?

Where does choice support learning, and where does it create drift?

What is the best tactic the moment requires?

Where might the method need to bend so the learner does not break?

One move I will try

Identify one part of the experience where you can vary the approach without changing the purpose.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Suggest variations for this experience while keeping the learning intention the same.

Chapter 9 Field Notes: The Army on the March

Use the questions that matter. Every optional AI prompt remains subject to the Use Gate and may use only permitted, genuinely non-identifying information.

What is the room whispering before it shouts?

What signals am I noticing in noise, silence, movement, materials, body language, or timing?

Who else helps me read the environment more clearly?

What small signal have I been ignoring because the larger problem has not arrived yet?

One move I will try

Watch one transition carefully. Do not only ask whether it worked. Ask what it revealed.

OPTIONAL AI COMPANION

Help me create a simple observation checklist for transitions and routines using visible starts, questions, participation, work progress, movement, materials, and timing. Do not infer an inner state.

Chapter 10 Field Notes: Terrain

These terrains describe conditions around learning. They do not define the learner.

ACCESSIBLE

Signal: The first step, purpose, language, and materials are within reach.

Strategic move: Protect clarity and momentum.

ENTANGLING

Signal: An early misunderstanding can make every later step harder to recover.

Strategic move: Build checkpoints before confusion grows roots.

TEMPORIZING

Signal: Pushing harder would create more pressure without creating more progress.

Strategic move: Pause and gather better information.

NARROW PASSES

Signal: Time, safety, materials, or competing demands leave little room for error.

Strategic move: Secure the essentials early.

PRECIPITOUS HEIGHTS

Signal: The challenge is advanced, high-pressure, or difficult to reverse.

Strategic move: Build skill, supported practice, and safety first.

DISTANT

Signal: The next milestone is not yet visible from the learner's current starting point.

Strategic move: Break the distance into visible milestones.

Chapter 10: The Terrain Check

Read the conditions without turning the terrain into a label.

Terrain I may be encountering

Which description helps me think without claiming certainty?

Evidence rather than assumptions

What have I actually seen, heard, read, or measured?

What is helping learning

What is quietly working against it

What must be protected

Wisest next move

Signal that the terrain has changed

Chapter 11 Field Notes: The Nine Situations

Use these as prompts, never as labels.

DISPERSIVE

Purpose is scattered. Create a shared centre.

FACILE

The learner has begun, but follow-through is not yet visible. Make the first step meaningful.

CONTENTIOUS

People are pulling toward competing advantages. Protect the purpose, not the contest.

OPEN

Choice is abundant. Give freedom a clear horizon.

INTERSECTING HIGHWAYS

Many people and pathways meet. Connect observations before drawing conclusions.

SERIOUS

The work carries real stakes. Protect the time, trust, materials, and support needed to continue.

DIFFICULT

Each step costs more. Make the next foothold visible without lowering the destination.

HEMMED-IN

The available options leave no visible respectful way back. Hold the boundary while keeping redemption possible.

DESPERATE

Safety or safeguarding has become the priority. Follow accountable procedures and involve the right support.

Chapter 11: The Situational Scan • Read

Use this page to think before reacting.

What I have actually observed

Separate evidence from motive.

Story or assumption I may have added

Alternative explanation I have not yet ruled out

Situation or situations that may help me think

More than one may be relevant.

Evidence that could prove my first reading incomplete

Chapter 11: The Situational Scan • Respond

The next move should protect the person and preserve the possibility of learning.

What must be protected first

Safety, dignity, trust, learning, time, or something else?

Who else may hold part of the picture**Smallest humane move****Signal that will tell me to change the strategy****What happened after the move****What the first reading missed**

Chapter 12: The Ethical Ignition Check • Design

Use before introducing a method powerful enough to change energy, pace, access, or direction.

Human capacity I am trying to ignite

Why this method is more useful than a quieter one

Situation and terrain surrounding the learners

Who has access, and who may be left outside the design

Boundaries protecting safety, dignity, privacy, integrity, and choice

Chapter 12: The Ethical Ignition Check • Evidence

The method is not successful simply because it creates activity.

Useful struggle that must remain with the learner

Evidence that will distinguish learning from activity or polished performance

Signal that will tell me to pause, redesign, or stop

What learners said, created, attempted, or understood

What I will keep, adapt, release, or investigate

Chapter 13: The Foreknowledge Check • Evidence

Understand before acting. Never reduce a learner to a profile.

What I have actually observed

What I have inferred or assumed

What the learner has had an appropriate opportunity to share

Source of the information and the limits of that source

Relevant perspective that may be missing

Chapter 13: The Foreknowledge Check • Ethics

Information is useful only when it opens support rather than closes possibility.

Evidence that could challenge my first interpretation

How this interpretation opens support rather than closes possibility

Educational or safeguarding purpose this information serves

Policy, permission, or professional authority that allows its use

Possible harm if the information or interpretation is wrong

Chapter 13: The Foreknowledge Check • Action

Choose a move that can be corrected when better information arrives.

Smallest humane and reversible action

When I will revisit the decision

New evidence that appeared

Who helped widen the picture

How the interpretation changed

Privacy reminder

Enter no names, pseudonyms, traceable learner codes, identifiable combinations, confidential information, private communications, or protected work. Changing or removing a name does not make information anonymous or create permission.

Field Tool 3: Reading the Room • Signals

Check only what you actually notice. A signal is not a diagnosis.

- ☐ Noise is rising without purpose.
- ☐ Long silence continues after the task begins.
- ☐ Movement no longer serves the task.
- ☐ Materials are being used without care.
- ☐ Learners are waiting without starting, and no next step is visible.
- ☐ Learners are rushing while skipping required reasoning or checks.
- ☐ Laughter repeatedly interrupts work or explanation.
- ☐ A learner's words, participation, or visible cues change enough to invite a respectful check-in.
- ☐ Learners finish quickly but cannot explain their choices or learning.
- ☐ Learners are busy but cannot explain what they are learning.

What I actually observed

Describe the signal without assigning motive.

What changed immediately before it

Field Tool 3: Reading the Room • Test

The better we name the possible problem, the wiser our response can become.

- ☐ This may involve task clarity.
- ☐ This may involve available support.
- ☐ This may involve interaction patterns.
- ☐ This may involve access to language or materials.
- ☐ This may involve task structure.
- ☐ This may involve timing or pacing.
- ☐ This may involve environmental conditions.
- ☐ This may involve purpose visibility.
- ☐ This may involve several interacting conditions.
- ☐ The explanation may still be unknown.

Evidence supporting or challenging this hypothesis

Treat the selection as a testable possibility, never an explanation of a learner's inner state.

Alternative explanation

What else might create the same visible signal?

Smallest response worth testing

Signal that will make me reconsider

Field Tool 4: The Student Strength Finder

When a learner is struggling, look again.

Where does this learner persist, contribute, or produce useful work?

Under which observable conditions do starts, sustained work, quality, or participation improve?

What do their explanations, questions, revisions, or completed work show?

Which tasks do they begin promptly, delay, leave incomplete, or return to?

With whom do they collaborate productively?

Which tasks produce stronger completion, explanation, revision, or care?

CHOOSE ONE MOVE

- ☐ Offer one meaningful responsibility.
- ☐ Make the first step smaller.
- ☐ Offer one choice with clear boundaries.
- ☐ Create one chance to teach, model, organize, lead, repair, explain, or create.

Evidence that will test or challenge this interpretation

Use the learner's voice when appropriate, observable evidence, and relevant colleague evidence.

Keep the interpretation open

A possible strength does not excuse unsafe behaviour or remove a clear boundary. Do not infer motive, emotion, personality, ability, or identity.

Field Tool 5: The Teacher Self-Check

Use before correcting a person or entering a difficult conversation.

- ☐ I am correcting behaviour, not trying to win the moment.
- ☐ I am protecting learning, not my ego.
- ☐ I have separated what happened from how it made me feel.
- ☐ My response keeps a respectful way back visible.
- ☐ My response preserves dignity.
- ☐ I can name the smallest firm move that protects safety while keeping the relationship possible.

Emotion I need to recognize before acting

Evidence that challenges my first story

Smallest firm move

How the person can return with dignity

Hold both.

Discipline without dignity creates resistance. Relationship without direction creates drift.

Field Tool 6: CRIT + Human Check • Use Gate and CRIT

Use whenever an intelligent system becomes part of teaching, learning, leadership, or design.

- ☐ PURPOSE - AI is necessary for this purpose, not merely available, and is likely to improve the outcome.
- ☐ POLICY - The exact system, purpose, age range, policy, data boundary, and tool conditions are authorized.
- ☐ BOUNDARY - I will enter only the minimum, genuinely non-identifying, non-sensitive information. A changed name does not create anonymity or permission.
- ☐ PROCEED - I can verify the output, protect people affected, and pause, reverse, or revise the workflow if evidence or authorization fails.

C - Context

Purpose, conditions, constraints, and minimum necessary information.

R - Role

Useful function or perspective, with limits stated.

I - Interview

Bounded questions, one at a time, with no personal disclosure.

T - Task

Required help, success criteria, evidence, and decisions AI must not make.

Use Gate

This is a prompt for judgment, not proof that a use is permitted. When any condition is uncertain, stop and return the work to the authorized human process.

Field Tool 6: CRIT + Human Check • Govern the Result

A disciplined prompt may improve an answer. It cannot guarantee truth or transfer responsibility.

Challenge

What may be wrong, missing, unfair, overconfident, or too easy?

Verify

What important claim have I checked independently, and with what source or evidence?

Decide

What will I accept, revise, or reject, and who owns the final choice?

Review

Can I explain the decision and the learning without hiding behind AI?

OUTCOME REVIEW

- ☐ The result improved learning, access, fairness, or sustainable workload - not output alone.
- ☐ A person affected can question or correct the result through an accountable human.
- ☐ I recorded what matters, corrected what failed, and deleted what no longer has a justified purpose.

High-stakes and profiling boundary

Safeguarding, diagnosis, discipline, placement, high-stakes grading, mental-health decisions, and confidential learner records remain inside authorized procedures. AI must not create learner personality profiles or infer inner states.

Attribution

CRIT is Geoff Woods's Context, Role, Interview, Task framework. The Human Check and this educational accountability routine are Pham's independent school-context application; no endorsement is claimed.

Field Tool 7: The 20/80 Value Audit

Use this as a focus lens, not a formula or outcome claim. Protect the human work and reduce only appropriate friction.

Learning capacity or relationship this task should strengthen

Purpose, context, ethics, or final judgment that must remain human

Productive struggle the learner must still experience

Information or decision that must not be delegated

Repetitive labour or friction AI may appropriately reduce

Options, comparison, organization, or first draft AI may provide

Human review required before anything reaches another person or record

Time or attention recovered and where it will be reinvested

Evidence of improved understanding, access, fairness, or wellbeing

What can the learner or educator now explain, use, revise, or transfer?

Keep the metaphor honest

The numbers are not outcome data, and they never mean a child should do only 20 percent of the thinking. Report any measured change using the actual measure.

Field Tool 8: Pattern Practice • Recognize and Use

Study patterns to prepare more wisely, not to trap people inside predictions.

Pattern I am noticing

What usually happens before it appears

Evidence that may challenge the pattern

What this pattern helps me prepare for

Response that could protect learning before the pattern grows stronger

Field Tool 8: Pattern Practice • Create and Transcend

Mastery means understanding a pattern deeply enough to follow it, adapt it, release it, or transcend it.

Better pattern this moment may require

Routine, question, structure, or experience that could make it repeatable

Person or system that may hold part of the picture

What another perspective may help me notice

Part of the pattern I should follow, adapt, release, or transcend

Wiser pattern I am ready to create

Field Tool 9: Growth Evidence Tracker • Purpose and Boundary

Optional advanced author pilot, ongoing through June 2027. This is live practitioner inquiry, not a validated instrument or required model for educators.

Use only when it is worth carrying

A simpler reflection is often the wiser move. This tracker studies observable teaching conditions and practice. It does not measure human worth or score a learner, colleague, class, or child.

BEFORE ANY TRACKER AI SUPPORT

- ☐ The exact system, purpose, documents, and data are authorized.
- ☐ No identifiers, pseudonyms, traceable learner codes, confidential data, private communications, or protected work are included.
- ☐ AI is limited to organizing, calculating, summarizing, or comparing aggregate, genuinely non-identifying lesson conditions.
- ☐ I will verify the evidence, invite relevant human perspectives, and make the decision myself.

The report remains human

Student-level evidence remains inside authorized school records. The proposed learner-reporting extension has not launched and is not authorized by this companion. No profiling, diagnosis, grading, or learner-level decision belongs in this tracker.

Inquiry period and purpose

Define the review window and what the evidence should help you understand.

Comparable lesson group

Keep materially different grades, units, durations, support, or unusual events separate.

Observable local anchors

Write what 0, 1, and 2 look or sound like before scoring; keep the anchors stable within the cycle.

Field Tool 9: Growth Evidence Tracker • Daily Snapshot

Collect observable evidence from every lesson. Synthesize one daily snapshot only across a defined group of reasonably comparable lessons.

Nine learning conditions, in order: Ready & Engaged; Choice & Focus; Studio Community; Clear Instruction; Environment Access; Key Concepts; Ways to Respond; Stretch & Explore; Develop Craft.

Rating and coverage

Use 0 for not yet visible, 1 for emerging or prompted, 2 for secure or independent, and N/O when evidence was not observed. Daily score = earned points / (2 x numeric checkpoints) x 100. Coverage = numeric checkpoints / 9 x 100. Round to whole percentages. If no checkpoints are rated numerically, report no score (N/O), 0 percent coverage, and MORE EVIDENCE unless PAUSE or VERIFY takes precedence.

Educator-created session label and lesson count

Use a genuinely non-identifying label. Do not enter a learner identifier, exact class code, or linkable combination.

Nine ratings in order

Enter 0, 1, 2, or N/O for each condition.

Observable evidence supporting the ratings

Record only the aggregate, non-identifying lesson implication in this companion.

Additional human perspective

Keep the attributable source in the approved record; note only its aggregate implication here.

One change, success signal, and accountable decision

Status order

PAUSE for critical safety or access; VERIFY for unconfirmed input; MORE EVIDENCE for fewer than six numeric ratings; REDESIGN for any confirmed 0; WATCH for any 1 or partial coverage; SECURE only when all nine ratings are 2. A score starts a question; it does not finish one.

Field Tool 9: Growth Evidence Tracker • Weekly Reflection

Score only what the evidence can support across comparable moments. Leave a lens blank when evidence is insufficient.

Ten lenses, in order: Purpose & clarity; Systems & sustainability; Relationship + standard; Conditions & access; Energy guided; Adaptation & terrain; Read before reacting; Ethical boundaries; Learner ownership; Teacher sustainability.

Weekly scale

Use 1 for not visible yet, 2 for emerging, 3 for mostly present, 4 for strong, and 5 for consistently strong and adaptive within this review period. Average only entered scores and record coverage.

Ten lens scores in order and coverage

Enter 1-5 or leave blank; then record lenses scored out of 10.

Strongest evidence and lens needing attention

Evidence that complicated or changed my first impression

Additional perspective and what changed because it had influence

Keep identities and attributable statements inside the authorized process.

One controllable move and success signal for next week

Coverage or context that limits comparison

Field Tool 9: Growth Evidence Tracker • Four-Week Cycle

After calibration, use the first complete four-week cycle as an initial baseline. Compare later cycles only when evidence and coverage are genuinely comparable.

Interpretation gate

A difference is not automatically growth, and a pattern is not proof of cause. Never use this reflection for staff ranking, employment decisions, or comparison of people.

Current and previous comparable daily averages with point change

Keep daily percentages separate from weekly 1-5 scores.

Current and previous four-week practice averages with point change

Strongest lens, recurring pattern, and unresolved question

Evidence or changed conditions that changed my mind

What should I carry, tune, or drop

One controllable change, comparable sessions, and success signal

Evidence the change was used as intended

Human decision, reason, and next review date

Choose KEEP, TUNE, or DROP. AI may summarize; it does not decide.

Field Tool 10: The Monday Move

If you do not know where to begin, begin small. Complete one before adding another.

- ☐ Ask one better question.
- ☐ Clarify one expectation.
- ☐ Repair one relationship.
- ☐ Rethink one routine.
- ☐ Notice one learner's work or participation more carefully.
- ☐ Prepare one alternative path.
- ☐ Listen to one piece of feedback without defending myself.
- ☐ After the Use Gate, use AI once to widen my thinking, then use my judgment to decide what belongs.

The one move I chose

Why this move matters now

Evidence I will watch for

What I learned before choosing another move

Field Tool 11: The Terrain Inquiry Cycle • Read

Choose one class, learning space, team, or recurring moment.

Inquiry question

What am I trying to understand rather than prove?

Condition that appears to be shaping learning

What makes me think so

Record evidence and its limits.

Where an assumption may be filling a gap

Condition I cannot control

Condition I can influence

Field Tool 11: The Terrain Inquiry Cycle • Respond and Observe

Change one condition so the evidence remains readable.

Single adjustment I will make

Why this adjustment is humane and reversible

What changed

What remained

Who responded differently

What I may still be missing

Field Tool 11: The Terrain Inquiry Cycle • Listen and Revise

A disciplined inquiry allows other perspectives and later evidence to correct the first reading.

What learners noticed

What colleagues, assistants, families, or support staff noticed

Evidence that contradicted my expectation

What I will keep, adapt, or release

Next wiser move

Date I will review again

Honest claim

This inquiry can improve reflection and local practice. It does not, by itself, establish that the framework causes a particular outcome.

Reality and Partner Check

Use when an interpretation may affect another person's opportunity, dignity, support, or future. Invite another perspective to widen the picture, not merely confirm yours.

Context shared without identifying details

No names, pseudonyms, traceable learner codes, or identifiable combinations.

My current interpretation

Treat it as a hypothesis, not a verdict.

Evidence supporting it

Evidence that does not fit

What another perspective noticed differently

Question that perspective raised

Evidence we still need

Smallest humane shared next move

What I am prepared to change

Field-Test Feedback

These questions may improve a future edition. Share no names, pseudonyms, traceable learner codes, identifiable combinations, confidential information, or protected work. Personal feedback is not universal evidence.

Tool or page tested

What felt immediately useful

What felt unclear, repetitive, or difficult to use

Prompt that changed how I saw the situation

Important perspective or context the tool missed

Would I use it again? Why or why not?

One change that would make the tool stronger

Final Reflection

The field is always changing. So must we.

What I now see more clearly

Where I still need humility

What I am ready to protect more deliberately

What I am ready to release

The next person or possibility I will look at differently

My next wiser move

Return to the field.

Prepare without becoming rigid. Care without losing judgment. Use tools without surrendering wisdom. Lead without forgetting the human being in front of you.